

		<i>School Dist. v. Trustees of the Southern California IBEW-NECA Pension Plan</i> (2010) 187 Cal.App.4th 621, 627-628.) In their Motion, Defendants have not presented any evidence that the depositions, or Plaintiffs’ discovery requests, are not relevant to the present action. Defendants also claim the noticed depositions conflict with pending hearings. (Yen Hai Bui Declaration, ¶ 4.) Defendants have not identified what hearings the noticed depositions might conflict with. Perhaps tellingly, Defendants’ meet-and-confer letter merely states they “are unavailable for the entire month of February due to multiple legal obligations and deadlines.” (Exhibit A to Defendants’ Declarations.) They also maintain that attempting to proceed with the noticed deposition “would place excessive pressure, create significant scheduling conflicts, and constitute harassment. Absent court intervention, this would cause irreparable harm, as once a deposition occurs under these conditions, the harm cannot be undone.” (Exhibit A to Defendants’ Declarations.) The Court acknowledges that a legitimate scheduling conflict might constitute good cause to reschedule the deposition. (See <i>Cisneros v. Department of Motor Vehicles</i> (2024) 104 Cal.App.5th 381, 420 [conflicting court appearance in a criminal matter represents good cause to continue civil administrative per se hearings].) A party may also object to a deposition notice if the deponent is unavailable on the date selected by the deposing party. However, having to comply with multiple legal obligations and deadlines, which may place excessive pressure on Defendants, does not constitute good cause. The fact that Defendants are self-represented does not warrant a different result. (See <i>Rappleyea v. Campbell</i> (1994) 8 Cal.4th 975, 984-985 [mere self-representation is not a ground for exceptionally lenient treatment, as the rules of civil procedure must apply equally to parties represented by counsel, as well as to those who forgo representation].) Since Defendants have not established good cause for the issuance of a protective order, the Court shall deny Defendants’ Motion for a protective order. Plaintiffs are ordered to provide notice of the Court’s ruling.
6	Nguyen vs. Volkswagen Group of America, Inc.	Defendant Volkswagen Group of America, Inc.’s Demurer to Plaintiff’s First Amended Complaint is OVERRULED as to the 6th Cause of Action. Defendant Volkswagen of Garden Grove’s Demurer to Plaintiff’s First Amended Complaint is OVERRULED as to the 5th Cause of Action.